



Practical Automation Readiness Checklist for SMEs

Find where automation can save time and money first.

Many businesses invest in automation too early, too broadly, or without clear ROI expectations.

This quick assessment helps warehousing, logistics, and manufacturing businesses (and not only) identify whether their operations are good candidates for practical automation improvements.

Quick Assessment

For each question, assign:

- **Yes** — 2 points
- **Partially** — 1 point
- **No** — 0 points

Process & Operations

Question	Score
Do you have repetitive manual tasks performed frequently?	
Do operational bottlenecks occur regularly?	
Are workflows reasonably standardized?	
Are employees spending significant time on low-value repetitive work?	

ROI & Business Impact

Question	Score
Could automation reduce operational errors or rework?	
Could automation improve throughput or capacity?	
Is ROI likely achievable within 12–36 months?	
Is this process important enough to justify investment?	

Practical Readiness for Implementation

Question	Score
Can new tools integrate with your existing systems?	
Is operational data already partially digitized?	
Can implementation happen incrementally?	
Is there internal ownership for the initiative?	

Scoring Guide

18–24 Points — Good Candidate for a First Automation Step

10–17 Points — Selective Automation Opportunities

Below 10 Points — Focus on Process Optimization First

Common Warning Signals Before Automating

- ☐ Processes constantly change
- ☐ Workflows are undocumented
- ☐ No measurable KPIs exist
- ☐ Trying to automate already inefficient operations

Important Perspective

Most SMEs do not need complex automation.

In many cases, workflow redesign, software integration, operational visibility, and process digitization create stronger ROI than physical automation systems.

The goal is to improve operational efficiency in a practical, financially sustainable way.

Next Steps

- ☐ Process assessment
- ☐ Bottleneck analysis
- ☐ ROI validation
- ☐ Pilot/prototype planning
- ☐ Simple first-step implementation plan